

AI Journal Creation Guide

Simple monthly process for creating the GoCardless journal

Audience: Data analysts and business users

Purpose: Create the monthly AI Journal and CSV file from prepared GoCardless remittance data.

Process at a Glance

1. Prepare the monthly records in the Input tab.
2. Save and close the workbook.
3. Run the analyser from the batch file.
4. Review the AI Journal, CSV, and Mapping checks.
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Folder Layout

The main folder should contain the analyser code and a Source Data folder:

```
AI_Automation\  
    excel_analyser.js  
    append_ai_analyser.ps1  
    Source Data\  
        GoCardless Generator [Month] JNL.xlsx
```

Keep the source workbook in Source Data. The analyser uses the default workbook found there.

Before You Start

Make sure you have:

1. Access to the AI_Automation folder.
2. The source workbook in the Source Data folder. Its name may include the month being processed.
3. The remittance records for the month you want to process.
4. Microsoft Excel and Node.js available on your computer.

Step-by-Step Process

1. Check the source workbook

Open the AI_Automation folder and confirm that the workbook is in the Source Data folder:

```
AI_Automation\Source Data\GoCardless Generator [Month] JNL.xlsx
```

2. Update the Input tab

Open the source workbook in Excel. Go to the Input tab and add or replace the remittance records for the month you want to process. Keep the existing column headings unchanged.

Important: records with resources.status equal to settled are automatically excluded from the journal.

Do not change the Map or AC_Map tabs unless the mapping has been reviewed and approved.

Save and close the workbook before running the analyser.

3. Run the analyser from the batch file

Close the source workbook, then open the AI_Automation folder in File Explorer. Double-click run_excel_analyser.bat. The batch file runs the analyser from the correct folder.

If the workbook does not use the default filename, drag the workbook file onto run_excel_analyser.bat. This passes the workbook path to the analyser.

Default workbook: Source Data\GoCardless Generator Jan JNL.xlsx

4. Wait for the batch file to finish

A command window opens and runs the analyser. Leave it open until processing finishes.

run_excel_analyser.bat

Do not close the batch window while it is running. The source workbook must be saved and closed before starting.

5. Check the completion message

A successful run confirms that the AI analyser, AI Journal, and CSV were created. It also shows the number of remittances analysed and the unmapped remittance count.

Output Files

After a successful run, check the following:

- AI analyser tab: contains the income distribution calculations and Mapping checks.
- AI Journal tab: contains the journal entries for import or review.
- Source Data\AI Journal.csv: contains the journal CSV export. Dates in column D use dd/mm/yyyy format.

The journal date and narration are based on the month containing the majority of the included transactions.

How Records Are Handled

Included records:

Remittance records in the Input tab that have a description and are not settled.

Excluded records:

Records where resources.status is settled.

Blank description rows.

The analyser ignores changing text after a branch name, such as amounts or other details after a colon.

Descriptions beginning with Refund for or Failure fee for use the matching underlying branch mapping when an exact Map row is not present.

Final Checks

Before using the journal, confirm:

- [] The AI Journal date is the expected month-end date.

- [] The narration shows the expected month and year.
- [] CSV column D contains dates in dd/mm/yyyy format.
- [] The analyser reports zero unmapped remittances, or all exceptions have been reviewed.
- [] Settled records have not been included.

If Unmapped Remittances Appear

Open the Mapping checks section in the AI analyser tab. Select the remittance count link to jump to the exact description in the Input tab. Review the description and confirm whether it should match an existing Map row.

Descriptions beginning with Refund for or Failure fee for use the underlying branch mapping when an exact Map row is not present.

Do not manually change the generated AI analyser or AI Journal tabs. Correct the source data or approved mapping, then run the analyser again.

Expected Successful Result

The batch window should confirm that the AI analyser tab, AI Journal tab, and CSV file were created. It should also report the number of remittances analysed and show:

```
unmapped remittances: 0
```

If the unmapped count is not zero, review the Mapping checks before using the journal.

Important Rules

- Do not delete the original Input, Map, or AC_Map tabs.
- Do not edit generated AI analyser or AI Journal tabs manually.
- Keep a copy of the original workbook before replacing monthly Input records.
- Run the analyser only after saving and closing the workbook.

Running More Than Once

If an AI analyser or AI Journal tab already exists, the analyser creates a versioned tab such as AI analyser V1 or AI Journal V1. Existing worksheets are not rewritten.

Review the newest versioned tabs and CSV file created by the latest run.

Troubleshooting

Workbook not found: confirm the workbook is in Source Data with the default filename, or drag the workbook onto run_excel_analyser.bat.

Excel is busy or locked: close the workbook, wait a few seconds, and run the command again.

Unmapped remittances: review the linked descriptions in Mapping checks before using the journal.

No output appears: double-click run_excel_analyser.bat again and confirm that Node.js is installed.